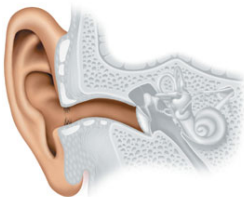


hearing

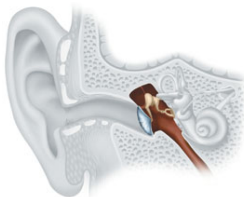
structure of the ear

The ear is made up of three distinct parts; hearing is controlled by the inner ear, which contains the sensory organs.



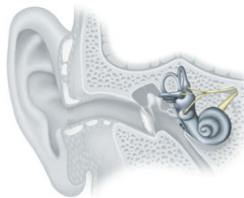
external ear

Visible portion of the ear enabling sounds to be collected and directed to the middle ear through the acoustic meatus.



middle ear

Air-filled cavity hollowed out of the temporal bone; it receives sounds from the external ear, amplifies them through the auricles and transmits them to the internal ear.

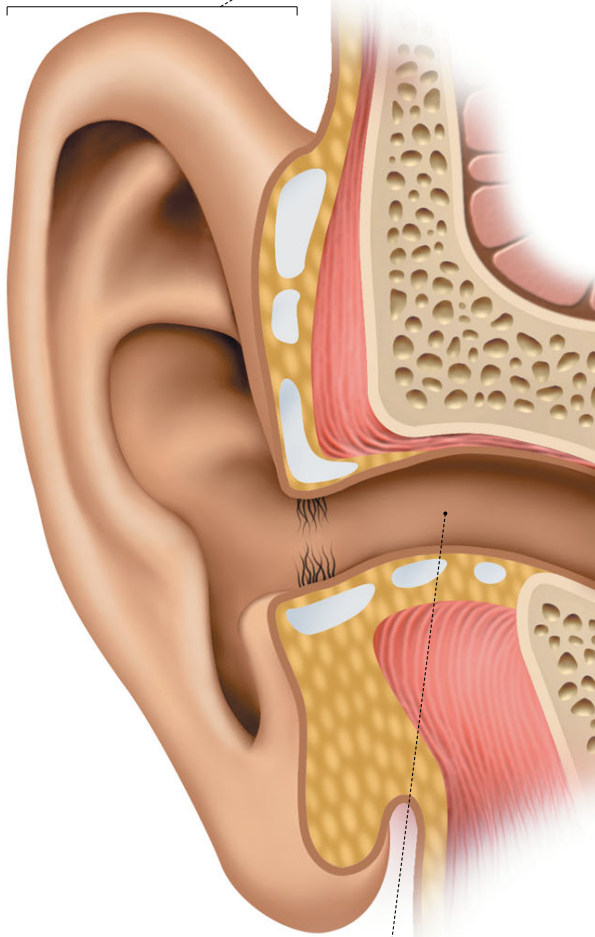


internal ear

Liquid-filled cavity hollowed out of the temporal bone that transforms sound vibrations into nerve impulses to be interpreted by the brain.

auricle

Soft cartilaginous outer portion of the ear located at the side of the head; it allows sounds to be collected.



acoustic meatus

Canal carrying the sounds collected by the pinna to the ear drum. It is lined with hair and covered with cerumen, a waxy substance that retains dust particles.